

Figure 2: Installing Monaca CLI, an Onsen UI toolkit

backing it, yet it is a somewhat stable framework now. However, as AngularJS 2 has come out into the market, designers are continually rolling out improvements and new features.

Onsen UI: To a great extent, this is very similar to Ionic. Everything said about Ionic also applies to Onsen UI. One of its plus points is that it can be used for classic Web development. Currently, it has a small community, which is growing slowly.

Kendo UI: Kendo UI is built around the JQuery framework. It can also be used with AngularJS. There are two versions -- one is free and the other is the commercial version. It also has theme builder support, offering many themes that look similar to native themes. It is used for mobile and classic Web development.

Sencha Touch: Sencha Touch uses vanilla JavaScript as the core (ExtJS). It used to be faster, but recent ExtJS changes are making it slower. It is a commercial product with a very good IDE.

JQuery Mobile: This is an HTML5 mark-up driven framework. JQuery is the additional layer of JavaScript. It is very easy to understand and implement. It is very slow compared to other frameworks, though, but has the support of a very large community.

Famo.US: Famo.US is built around AngularJS and follows a completely different approach for mobile development. It is a 2D/3D engine for game development and currently is one of the faster frameworks. But there are very few samples available and very little community support.

AngularJS is difficult to understand compared to JQuery. Many people like the JQuery framework, but it is slow compared to other frameworks.

Monaca IDE, a great tool for Onsen UI

Monaca is a development platform for hybrid mobile app development with PhoneGap/Cordova. It is very easy to use and integrate with existing workflows. It also supports Cloud IDE, remote online build and CLI debugger.



Figure 3: Create a project



Figure 4: Choosing a framework and version

Installing Onsen UI

There are different ways to work with Onsen UI. Let's first deploy it with the Monaca CLI.

- First, we need to install Node.js from *https://nodejs.org/en/*.
- The next step is to install the Monaca CLI using npm.

```
npm install -g monaca
```

- By installing the Monaca CLI, we will get a command line interface for Onsen UI development. For GUI mode, install the Monaca Toolkit from the link *https://monaca.io/localkit.html*
- Now, let's create a project based on Onsen UI:

```
monaca create helloonsenUI
```

Choose any framework that you want for development. Once you have selected one, download the appropriate template and create the project.

- We will now run this project on the device by using the following commands:

```
cd helloonsenUI
monaca preview # preview in the browser

monaca debug # Run on the device in debugger
monaca remote build # Build the app
monaca remote build android # Build the android app (Choose any OS, which you want to build)
```

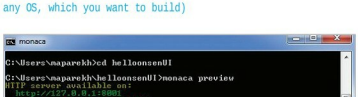


Figure 5: App preview